



1100 Pennsylvania Av
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ortc@ohiorivertrail.org

Ohio River Trail Council

"Joining communities through fitness, recreation, heritage and transportation networks"

Ohio River Trail - Phase I

August 10, 2012. Monaca, Pa. The Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) was formed several years ago and began to undertake various planning and community revitalization related initiatives along the Ohio River Valley Corridor.

The Ohio River Trail Council is in full support of a progressing state and national movement to develop greenways, especially since 1987 when President Reagan's Commission on "American Outdoors" recommended establishing a national greenways network and Pennsylvania Governor Tom Ridge vision in 2001 to create a network of trails throughout the Commonwealth, with a greenway in every community by 2020.

The National Park Service Rivers, Trails, and Conservation Assistance (RTCA) Program has recognized the importance of the Ohio River Trail Project by bestowing a two-year award. The Ohio River Trail is part of the "*Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area*", "*Lewis & Clark Trail*" and is a candidate for part of the *U.S. Bicycle Route 50* and a portion of the *Underground Railroad Trail, Pittsburgh spur*. The Ohio River Trail will also follow sections of the "*Great Path*" and the "*Lincoln Highway*."

Furthermore, the Ohio River Trail Council proposes the broad vision of a tri-state greenway system between Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia. The Ohio River Trail will serve to complete a key segment in a nationally significant trail. The proposed Ohio River Trail will unite the "*Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway*" in Columbiana County, Ohio to the "*Great Allegheny Passage*" in Allegheny County, Pennsylvania and continuing on the C&O Canal Towpath National Historic Site, forming a mega-trail from the great lakes region to our nation's capitol. This mega-greenway has substantial support from the Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources.

The "Ohio River Trail - Phase I" is part of the Ohio River Trail Council overall plan to develop a forty-one (41) mile multi-use land & water trail system along the Ohio River and its tributaries, known as the Ohio River Trail (ORT). The corridor runs from Coraopolis, PA to Ohioville, PA near the three-way intersection of Ohio, Pennsylvania and the northern tip of West Virginia.

In 2009, the Ohio River Trail Council along with eight communities and two counties received a Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (PA-DCNR) Planning Grant to prepare a feasibility study to link the South Shore communities in Allegheny and Beaver County together via a multi-modal trail and public access to and along the Ohio River.

The South Shore Feasibility Study is complete and has identified a series of proposed recommendations to create a trail which links the current 46-mile Montour Trail from Coraopolis Borough to Moon Township, Crescent Township, South Heights, Hopewell Township, Aliquippa, Center Township, Monaca, Neville Township, and Sewickley, Pa. From this study, comes the "Ohio River Trail - Phase I" project. Phase I is an exciting transportation prospect in that it will connect three wonderful greenspace and recreational projects, the planned seventy-eight (78) acre Allegheny County Sports & Athletic Complex in Coraopolis, the proposed Moon Township Waterfront Park and the existing Sewickley Riverfront Park.



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"Joining communities through fitness, recreation, heritage and transportation networks"

Support for the Ohio River Trail Project is widespread. Most importantly, funds are anticipated from the Federal Highway Administration, State Department of Conservation and Natural Resources, Allegheny County along with corporate and individual sources to permit the engineering and construction of the greenway project.

The total cost of the "Ohio River Trail - Phase I" is \$250,000. To date, Phase I has been awarded a \$200,000 grant from the Transportation, Community and System Preservation Program (TCSP). TCSP funds will help prepare engineering, specifications, bid documents and permits to construct a 2.5-mile segment of the Ohio River Trail between Coraopolis Borough and Moon Township including a link to the Sewickley Bridge in Allegheny County.

The ORTC communities and partners are encouraged about this opportunity to start implementation of the Feasibility Studies and to show on-the-ground success. The Ohio River Trail Council is an organization committed to excellence, with a clear vision and a passion for delivering outstanding results. We ask you to work with us to capitalize on these strengths. The Ohio River Trail Council membership plays an integral role in the continued development of the ORTC's Land and Water Trails, as well as our ability to serve southwestern Pennsylvania riverfront communities through advocacy and planning. The council would like to invite you to become a member and endorse our efforts in making the Ohio River Trail a reality. Please support our mission to honor our past and build our future by providing recreation opportunities, environmental stewardship, heritage development, safe transportation networks and economic stimulus to our region.

Respectfully submitted,

Vincent Troia

Vincent Troia
Chief Executive Officer



ALLEGHENY COUNTY
ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

January 5, 2012

The Honorable Ray H. LaHood
Secretary of the U. S. Department of Transportation
1200 New Jersey Ave., SE
Washington, D.C. 20590-0001

RE: Ohio River Trail TCSP Grant Application

Dear Mr. Secretary:

As Director of Allegheny County Economic Development, I strongly support the Ohio River Trail Council's application for a Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program (TCSP) grant for a 2.5-mile bike/pedestrian segment of the Ohio River Trail in Allegheny County, Pennsylvania.

The implementation of this first segment will benefit other trail projects which are identified as priority projects within Allegheny County's Comprehensive Plan, *Allegheny Places*. The trail will connect important riverfront municipalities to the County's Sports Legacy Project, which is located in three of Allegheny County's municipalities (the Borough of Coraopolis and the Townships of Moon and Robinson). And at that juncture, the trail system will connect to the Montour Trail, a segment of the Great Allegheny Passage. Additionally, Allegheny County and Friends of the Riverfront are engaged in the planning of the extension of the Three Rivers Heritage Trail from the City of Pittsburgh to the Sports Legacy Project.

In addition, the Ohio River Trail is part of the recommendations of *ActiveAllegheny*, the county's comprehensive commuter bike, pedestrian, and complete streets plan. Trail and greenway development supports quality of life and economic development activities.

I look forward to the implementation of an important connecting segment of our trail system.

If you have any questions, please contact Ms. Darla J. Cravotta, Special Projects Coordinator, at 412-350-4318.

Sincerely,

Dennis M. Davin
Director

DJC/AHH/mac

C: Dr. Vincent Troia, Ohio River Trail Council
Ms. Darla Cravotta, Special Projects Coordinator, Allegheny County
Mr. Robert D. Hurley, Deputy Director, ACED
Ms. Lynn Heckman, Assistant Director, ACED
Ms. Kay Pierce, Manager, Planning Division, ACED



pennsylvania

DEPARTMENT OF CONSERVATION
AND NATURAL RESOURCES

OFFICE OF CONSERVATION AND TECHNICAL SERVICES

January 5, 2012

The Honorable Ray LaHood
Secretary of Transportation
U.S. Department of Transportation
1200 New Jersey Avenue, SE
Washington, DC 20590-0001

Dear Secretary LaHood:

The Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (DCNR) is pleased to support the Transportation, Community and System Preservation Program (TCSP) grant application for the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC).

This 2.5-mile bike/ped segment of the Ohio River Trail will be a "major link" to the existing trail systems of The Great Allegheny Passage and C&O Canal Towpath, which currently spans 335 miles from Washington D.C. to Pittsburgh PA. DCNR is committed to extending this major greenway system and has partnered with ORTC by funding two feasibility studies along the entire span of the 41-mile Ohio River corridor (Pittsburgh to the Ohio State border). This 41-mile study area has shown great local support by bringing together 27 municipalities and 2 county governments. The focus of this application is to capitalize on the momentum of the study through the implementation of the South Shore Trail.

DCNR has also been very active in a Tri-State-Trail Committee whose members include the states of Ohio, West Virginia and Pennsylvania. The Ohio River Corridor is a "vital link" to connecting the Northwest to the "Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway" in Columbiana County Ohio, forming a major greenway and trail from the great lakes region to our nation's capital.

At the local level, this trail will also connect two planned recreational amenities. First, Allegheny County is making a large investment in a state of the art "Allegheny County Sports and Athletic Complex" at Montour Junction. Currently DCNR is entertaining a grant application for the development of this 75-acre Brownfield site. Additionally, Moon Township is working on the "Moon Township Waterfront Park". DCNR has supported their effort through a Master Site Development Plan of this 17-acre waterfront park.

conserve

sustain

enjoy

DCNR has committed substantial funding over the years to Pennsylvania's major greenway corridors and is committed to closing these gaps. A key recommendation of Pennsylvania's national award winning Statewide Outdoor Recreation Plan (2009-2013) is to promote green and walkable communities. The plan identified walking as the most popular outdoor recreation activity and bike lanes as the most requested facility. These corridors are currently hampered by critical gaps that limit their utility and deter their use by a greater number of people. Closing this gap on one of Pennsylvania's priority greenway corridors will:

- Strengthen the connections between 27 communities throughout the Ohio River corridor.
- Provide alternative transportation options to residents and visitors alike to access communities, workplaces, natural & recreational resources, as well as cultural & historic sites.
- Improve safety by providing an alternate route off of state routes and narrow township roads for pedestrians and bicyclists.
- Increase economic opportunities for entrepreneurs by creating a continuous long distance trail "spine" to capture and retain visitors.

Finally, if funded, this project will support livability components by providing a multi-modal opportunity in Pennsylvania that will "expand transportation choices and foster connections to places people work, play, and live." Thank you for considering this request.

Sincerely,



Cindy Adams Dunn
Deputy Secretary
for Conservation and Technical Services



MONTOUR TRAIL COUNCIL * 304 HICKMAN STREET * SUITE #3 * BRIDGEVILLE, PA 15017

January 5, 2012

To Whom It May Concern,

Please consider the following as a letter of support for the Ohio River Trail Council's grant application to the Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program. It is our hope that funding would be granted to Ohio River Trail Council for the realization of a 2.5 mile bicycle and pedestrian trail in Western Pennsylvania.

The Montour Trail Council has been building trail for over twenty years and can offer first hand testimony on the significance of grant monies to accomplish our objective. The Ohio River Trail Council has worked hard to establish strong community support, educate the public and address the concerns of the residents in the twenty- seven (27) municipalities and townships along the forty-one (41) mile proposed trail. Funding request for this first portion of the trail would benefit the communities involved and encourage other communities to recognize the recreational and economical benefits of a trail in their neighborhood.

The Montour Trail Council fully supports the Ohio River Trail Council's request for grant funding. We hope to continue to serve our trail users and welcome the addition of the Ohio River Trail.

Please contact me for any questions you may have at the following email mtcoffice@montourtrail.org or by phone at 412 257-3011. Please consider this worthwhile application.

Sincerely,

Phyllis McChesney
Montour Trail Council
Airport Area Friends of the Montour Trail, President



United States Department of the Interior

NATIONAL PARK SERVICE

Northeast Region

Rivers, Trails and Conservation Assistance Program

West Virginia Field Office

West Virginia University

P.O. Box 6125, 325 Percival Hall, Evansdale Drive

Morgantown, WV 26506-6125

IN REPLY REFER TO:
Ohio River Trail

January 2, 2012

To Whom It May Concern,

This letter is in support of the Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program (TCSP) grant application for a 2.5-mile bike/ped segment of the Ohio River Trail in PA.

As an Outdoor Recreation Planner with National Park Service's Rivers & Trails Program, one of my technical assistance projects this year is with the Ohio River Trail Council. Our focus is to start implementation of the Ohio River Trail vision. This grant application is one step toward that goal.

The Ohio River Trail (ORT) project is a partnership project between the Ohio River Trail Council and the 27 municipalities along the 41-mile proposed trail that follows the shores of the Ohio River, just downstream from Pittsburgh. The Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (PA-DCNR) has supported this vision through grants for two Feasibility Studies – the North Shore and the South Shore sections. For this application, the focus is to start implementation of the ORT South Shore Trail Feasibility Study.

This first section of trail is identified in the Feasibility Study, and is only 2.5 miles long, but will make a major link to existing trail systems from Pittsburgh to Washington DC, following the Montour Rail-Trail, the Great Allegheny Passage, and the C&O Canal Towpath. When completed, the ORT will continue the linkage to the northwest, to the "Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway" in Columbiana County, Ohio, forming a mega-trail from the great lakes region to our nation's capitol. This grant application requests funds for design and engineering drawings and construction specifications for implementation of the first phase of the Feasibility Study.

The Ohio River Trail project is part of the Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area, and is located in a metropolis of 27 linked municipalities, working to recover from the economic downslide of the industrial era and to rebuild the riverfronts to a point of pride. The Ohio River Trail will provide a safe route for alternative transportation on foot and on bicycles.

Please give strong consideration to this worthy grant application. Feel free to contact me by phone or email, at 304.293.7528, or peggy_pings@nps.gov.

Sincerely,

Peggy Pings



3 January 2012

Dr. Vincent Troia, Executive Chairman & CEO
Ohio River Trail Council
1100 Pennsylvania Ave
Monaca, PA 15061

Dear Dr. Troia:

The Rivers of Steel Heritage Corp. (ROS) is proud to partner with and support the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC), a non-profit volunteer-led corporation that is dedicated to bring individuals, groups, councils, organizations, schools, conservancies, communities, companies, corporations, recreational users and all levels of government together to promote and protect a continuous corridor of natural and cultural resources along the Ohio River and its tributaries. The ORTC is serving as a unification tool by providing a resource and a forum for its local citizens, decision makers, and project managers to share knowledge in order to guarantee a bright future for our rivers, forests, and towns.

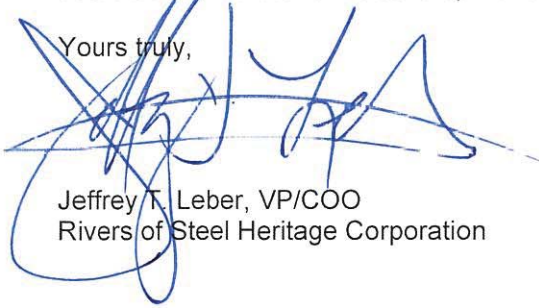
The Ohio River Trail Council supports the state and national movement to develop a national greenways network. Greenways are often accomplished and managed through partnerships between municipalities, counties, and non-profit organizations. Pennsylvania's statewide greenways program was established in 2001 to promote and support the greenway efforts occurring in all sixty-seven counties. "The vision is to create a network of trails throughout the Commonwealth, with a greenway in every community by 2020." The ORTC's goal is to honor our past and build our future by providing recreation opportunities, environmental stewardship, heritage development, safe transportation networks and economic stimulus to our community.

The Ohio River Trail Council is currently planning & developing a forty-one (41) mile multi-use land & water trail system along the Ohio River and its tributaries, known as the Ohio River Trail. The corridor runs from Coraopolis, PA to Ohioville, PA at the U.S. Public Land Survey "Point of Beginning", a National Historic Landmark located near the three-way intersection of Ohio, Pennsylvania and the northern tip of West Virginia.

The Ohio River Trail is part of the "Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area", "Lewis & Clark Trail" and is being considered for part of the U.S Bicycle Route 50 and a portion of the Underground Railroad Trail, Pittsburgh spur. The Ohio River Trail will also follow sections of the "Great Path" and the "Lincoln Highway". The ORTC proposes the broad vision of a tri-state greenway system between Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia.

The proposed Ohio River Trail will unite the "Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway" in Columbiana County, Ohio to the "Great Allegheny Passage" in Allegheny, County Pennsylvania forming a mega-trail from the great lakes region to our nation's capitol. ROS has witnessed first-hand the impact of the Great Allegheny Passage in providing recreation to trail users as well as economic development opportunities to the small towns and businesses adjacent and nearby the trail.

Yours truly,


Jeffrey T. Leber, VP/COO
Rivers of Steel Heritage Corporation



TOWN CENTER
ASSOCIATES

January 4, 2012

Dr. Vincent Troia, Executive Chairman
Ohio River Trail Council
1100 Pennsylvania Avenue
Monaca, PA 15061

Re: 2012 TCSP Grant Application
Coraopolis Borough

Dear Dr. Troia:

Town Center is very pleased to have the opportunity to collaborate with the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) in this important grant application for design services relative to the 2012 Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program (TCSP).

Our firm provides comprehensive support services, under Allegheny County Economic Development (ACED) for its Allegheny Together Program, an economic development initiative for selected traditional downtown-based communities in Allegheny County. Coraopolis is one of the communities participating in this program. Town Center also provides a parallel system of support for 10 Beaver County commercial districts (The Beaver County Main Street Network).

Because of the nature of our work in these two Western Pennsylvania counties, we find that the regional developmental goals of ORTC blend perfectly with the revitalization efforts in the communities we represent, and nowhere is this more evident than in Coraopolis Borough. The project envisioned in the TCSP application being submitted on behalf of Coraopolis will not only greatly facilitate the revitalization of the core business district in that community, but will have direct and immediate impact on residents in Sewickley Borough and Moon Township as well.

The trail project in Coraopolis has quite dynamic implications. Coraopolis is situated at the extreme southern end of the Ohio River Trail, and at the same time represents the first traditional business district that will connect with the already developed Montour Trail. Coraopolis will be the "missing link" between these two wonderful trail systems, able to provide the kinds of services much-needed by cycling and recreational enthusiasts.

The energetic efforts of you (and your ORTC volunteers) have truly been inspirational to the members of the Coraopolis Business District Advisory Committee, and to the entire staff at Town Center Associates as well. Please let us know if we can be of further assistance as your very worthy project moves forward.

Sincerely

Mark J. Peluso

Mark J. Peluso, Executive Director

TOWN CENTER ASSOCIATES

Pittsburgh Office: One Oxford Center 412-577-7447

Business Office: Beaver PA 724-728-0500

1147 Third Street, Beaver, PA 15009

www.towncenter.info

ROBERT P. CASEY, JR.
PENNSYLVANIA

COMMITTEES:
AGRICULTURE, NUTRITION,
AND FORESTRY

FOREIGN RELATIONS

HEALTH, EDUCATION,
LABOR, AND PENSIONS

SPECIAL COMMITTEE ON AGING

JOINT ECONOMIC

United States Senate

WASHINGTON, DC 20510

January 18, 2012

Mr. Victor M. Mendez
Administrator
Federal Highway Administration
U.S Department of Transportation
1200 New Jersey Ave SE
Washington, DC 20590

Dear Mr. Mendez:

It is my understanding that the Ohio River Trail Council has submitted an application to the Federal Highway Administration's Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program (TCSP). The purpose of this letter is to urge you to give full and fair consideration to this proposal.

I am informed that the Ohio River Trail Council is a nonprofit corporation in southwestern Pennsylvania dedicated to promoting and protecting a continuous corridor of natural and cultural resources along the Ohio River. I have been advised that the Council is currently planning and developing a forty-one (41) mile multi-use land and water trail system along the Ohio River and is receiving technical support from the National Park Service. I am further advised that the Council would utilize TCSP funding for the design and engineering of its first phase of implementation of the South Shore Trail that will connect communities along the existing Montour Trail in Allegheny County. As it appears, the project will provide trail access and improved recreational activity and mobility to the residents of communities in both Allegheny and Beaver Counties along the Ohio River.

Thank you in advance for the consideration of my views. Please include this letter in the official record of the application. Consistent with all applicable laws, rules and regulations, I also respectfully request that you keep me informed of the status of this grant application. Finally, if you have any questions, comments or concerns, please feel free to contact my staff at (412) 803-7370.

Sincerely,



Robert P. Casey, Jr.
United States Senator

JASON ALTMIRE
4TH DISTRICT, PENNSYLVANIA

COMMITTEE ON
TRANSPORTATION AND
INFRASTRUCTURE

COMMITTEE ON
EDUCATION AND THE WORKFORCE



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2124 FREEPORT ROAD
NATRONA HEIGHTS, PA 15065
(724) 226-1304
FAX: (724) 226-1308

Congress of the United States
House of Representatives
Washington, DC 20515

January 5, 2012

Honorable Ray H. LaHood
Secretary
U. S. Department of Transportation
1200 New Jersey Ave., SE
Washington, DC 20590-0001

Dear Secretary LaHood,

I am writing this letter in support of the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) in its application for a Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program (TCSP) grant through the U.S. Department of Transportation.

Funding from this grant, should the ORTC receive it, would be used to complete design, engineering, and construction specification work on the first phase of the South Shore Trail. As part of the forty-one mile Ohio River Trail, this section of the trail extends existing trail systems along the Ohio River and into the city of Coraopolis, PA, and provides a connection to the communities of Sewickley, Edgeworth, Leetsdale, and Ambridge, PA. The valuable and widely supported Ohio River Trail will establish a tri-state corridor of natural and cultural resources between Ohio, Pennsylvania, and West Virginia that provides recreational opportunities, attracts investment, and creates safe transportation networks.

I am pleased to lend my strong support to the Ohio River Trail Council's application and I hope your office will give its request full consideration. If you have any questions regarding this matter please contact my District Director, Michelle Dorothy, at michelle.dorothy@mail.house.gov or 724-378-0928. Thank you for your time and attention to this important issue.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in cursive script that reads "Jason Altmire".

Jason Altmire
Member of Congress

JA: cgm

Cc: Vincent Troia, Ohio River Trail Council CEO

MARK S. CRITZ
12TH DISTRICT, PENNSYLVANIA

COMMITTEE ON ARMED SERVICES

COMMITTEE ON SMALL BUSINESS



Congress of the United States

House of Representatives

Washington, DC 20515

January 3, 2012

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FAX: (202) 225-5709

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JOHNSTOWN, PA 15901
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TOLL FREE TO PENNSYLVANIA OFFICES:
1-800-289-2642

www.critz.house.gov

The Honorable Ray H. LaHood
Secretary
U. S. Department of Transportation
1200 New Jersey Ave., SE
Washington, DC 20590-0001

Dear Secretary LaHood:

I write to you in support of the Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program (TCSP) grant application for a 2.5-mile bike/ped segment of the Ohio River Trail in PA.

The Ohio River Trail (ORT) project is part of the Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area, and is located in a metropolis of 27 linked municipalities working to recover economically and environmentally from the decline of the industrial era. The ORT, which includes over 41 miles of proposed shoreline of the Ohio River just downstream from Pittsburgh, has been supported by the Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (PA-DCNR) through grants for two Feasibility Studies.

While the initial section of the ORT is only 2.5 miles long, it will link existing trail systems from Pittsburgh to Washington DC, following the Montour Rail-Trail, the Great Allegheny Passage, and the C&O Canal Towpath.

This project represents an opportunity to link the midatlantic trail systems in such a way that would catalyze future development throughout the region. Thus, it is with great pleasure that I am afforded the opportunity to provide my support for this project

Thank you for your continued leadership; I urge you to give this application for funding your highest consideration

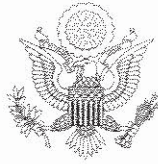
Sincerely,

MARK S. CRITZ
Member of Congress

MSC:ck

TIM MURPHY
18TH DISTRICT, PENNSYLVANIA

COMMITTEE ON ENERGY AND COMMERCE
HEALTH
COMMERCE, TRADE AND CONSUMER PROTECTION



CO-CHAIR, STEEL CAUCUS
CO-CHAIR, 21ST CENTURY HEALTH
CARE CAUCUS
CO-CHAIR, MENTAL HEALTH CAUCUS
CO-CHAIR, FRIENDS OF IRELAND
SUBURBAN CAUCUS

WEBSITE: murphy.house.gov

Congress of the United States
House of Representatives
Washington, DC 20515

January 17, 2012

Honorable Ray LaHood
Secretary
U.S. Department of Transportation
1200 New Jersey Ave SE
Washington, D.C. 20590

Dear Secretary LaHood:

I am writing to call your attention to the Ohio River Trail Council and its application for financial assistance from the Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program for a 2.5-mile bike and pedestrian trail.

The Ohio River Trail project is part of the Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area's efforts to restore communities that were once thriving because of the steel industry. The project will extend the existing Montour Trail and Great Allegheny Passage into the core of downtown Coraopolis, and along the Ohio River to Moon Township. The 2.5 mile trail is part of a larger initiative by the Ohio River Trail Council to complete a 41-mile trail connecting 27 municipalities along the Ohio River.

This project is intended to benefit the Southwestern Pennsylvania region by providing increased economic and recreational opportunities for communities involved and along the trail. Once the 41-mile trail project is completed, it will have created a system of trails connecting Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia together.

I urge you to give this proposal for funding your full and fair consideration. Thank you for your time attention to this matter.

Sincerely,


Tim Murphy
Member of Congress

JIM MARSHALL, MEMBER
14TH Legislative District

PO Box 202014
Harrisburg, PA 17120-2014
Phone: (717) 260-6432
Fax: (717) 772-9869

1122 7th Avenue
Beaver Falls, PA 15010
Phone: (724) 847-1352
Fax: (724) 847-5283



House of Representatives
Commonwealth of Pennsylvania
Harrisburg

Committees

Aging and Older Adult Services
Commerce
Transportation
Veterans Affairs and
Emergency Preparedness

E-mail: jmarshall@pahousegop.com
Website: www.RepMarshall.com

January 4, 2012

To Whom It May Concern,

This letter is to add my endorsement in support of the Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program (TCSP) grant application for a 2.5-mile bike/ped segment of the Ohio River Trail in PA.

The Ohio River Trail (ORT) project is a partnership project between the Ohio River Trail Council and the 27 municipalities along the 41-mile proposed trail that follows the shores of the Ohio River, just downstream from Pittsburgh. The Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (PA-DCNR) has supported this vision through grants for two Feasibility Studies – the North Shore and the South Shore sections. For this application, the focus is to start implementation of the ORT South Shore Trail Feasibility Study.

This first section of trail is identified in the Feasibility Study, and is only 2.5 miles long, but will make a major link to existing trail systems from Pittsburgh to Washington DC, following the Montour Rail-Trail, the Great Allegheny Passage, and the C&O Canal Towpath. When completed, the ORT will continue the linkage to the northwest, to the “Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway” in Columbiana County, Ohio, forming a mega-trail from the great lakes region to our nation’s capitol. This grant application requests funds for design and engineering drawings and construction specifications for implementation of the first phase of the Feasibility Study.

The Ohio River Trail project is part of the Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area, and is located in a metropolis of 27 linked municipalities, working to recover from the economic downslide of the industrial era and to rebuild the riverfronts to a point of pride. The Ohio River Trail will provide a safe route for alternative transportation on foot and on bicycles.

I urge your favorable review of TCSP’s application and thank you for allowing me the opportunity to express my support for this Ohio River Trail project.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Jim Marshall".

JIM MARSHALL
State Representative
14th Legislative District

ROBERT F. MATZIE, MEMBER
16TH LEGISLATIVE DISTRICT

☐ 121 IRVIS OFFICE BUILDING
P.O. BOX 202016
HARRISBURG, PENNSYLVANIA 17120-2016
PHONE: (717) 787-4444
FAX: (717) 780-4772

SEND ALL DISTRICT CORRESPONDENCE HERE
AMBRIDGE OFFICE:

☒ 1240 MERCHANT STREET, 1ST FLOOR
AMBRIDGE, PENNSYLVANIA 15003
PHONE: (724) 266-7774
(412) 565-3569
FAX: (724) 266-7634

☐ BELLEVUE SATELLITE OFFICE:
BELLEVUE BOROUGH BUILDING
537 BAYNE AVENUE
PITTSBURGH, PENNSYLVANIA 15202
PHONE: (412) 761-1701
FAX: (412) 761-1721
TUESDAYS 9 A.M. TO 4:30 P.M.

WWW.PAHOUSE.COM/MATZIE



House of Representatives
COMMONWEALTH OF PENNSYLVANIA
HARRISBURG

COMMITTEES

COMMERCE – DEMOCRATIC SUBCOMMITTEE
CHAIR ON HOUSING
CONSUMER AFFAIRS
DEMOCRATIC POLICY
INSURANCE
TOURISM AND RECREATION – DEMOCRATIC
SUBCOMMITTEE CHAIR ON TRAVEL
PROMOTION, HISTORY AND HERITAGE

SPECIAL APPOINTMENTS

PENNSYLVANIA HISTORICAL AND MUSEUM
COMMISSION
LEGISLATIVE DATA PROCESSING COMMITTEE

January 3, 2012

Dr. Vincent Troia
1100 Pennsylvania Ave.
Monaca, PA 15061

Dear Dr. Troia:

I am writing to express my support for the Ohio River Trail Council's 2012 Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program (TCSP) grant application and your continuing efforts to construct the Ohio River Trail.

The proposal for a multi-use trail, along the Ohio River and its tributaries from West Virginia and Ohio to Beaver and Allegheny County in Pennsylvania is an ambitious, but viable undertaking. The proposed trail which would connect the pending Allegheny County Sports Complex and existing Montour Trail, through Coraopolis to the proposed Moon Township Waterfront Park and Sewickley Bridge will be a welcome addition to the quality of life for our region.

Again, I fully support the Ohio River Trail Council's request for grant funding from the TCSP program.

It is a pleasure to be of assistance to you in this way and please do not hesitate to contact me if I can ever be of service in the future.

Thank you.

Sincerely,

Handwritten signature of Robert F. Matzie in black ink.
ROBERT F. MATZIE
STATE REPRESENTATIVE

"SERVING ALLEGHENY & BEAVER COUNTIES"

**42ND DISTRICT
WAYNE D. FONTANA**

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Senate of Pennsylvania

January 6, 2012

COMMITTEES

COMMUNITY, ECONOMIC & RECREATIONAL
DEVELOPMENT, DEMOCRATIC CHAIR
APPROPRIATIONS
LAW & JUSTICE
POLICY
URBAN AFFAIRS & HOUSING

To Whom It May Concern:

Please consider this letter as evidence of my support of the Ohio River Trail Council's Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program (TCSP) grant application.

This funding would be used to implement the first phase of the South Shore Trail Feasibility Study, a 2.5-mile trail connecting a proposed sports complex and the existing Montour trail through Coraopolis Borough along the Ohio River to Moon Township. The Council's vision for the trail was supported by a grant through the Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources for this feasibility study. The South Shore Trail would ultimately link eight separate communities along the Ohio River encompassing more than 12 miles of riverfront green space. This portion of the project, the 2.5-mile trail, is significant in that it would link communities to existing trails that connect Pittsburgh to Washington, D.C.

Thank you, in advance, for allowing me to offer this letter of support. I urge the Department of Transportation to look favorably upon this application so that the Ohio River Trail Council can continue its effort to link communities through greenways that promote efficiency and environmental stewardship.

Sincerely,

Wayne D. Fontana
State Senator, 42nd Senatorial District

WDF/kpw

TOWNSHIP OF MOON

Municipal Center

1000 Beaver Grade Road • Moon Township, PA 15108-2984
Telephone: 412-262-1700 • Fax: 412-262-5344 • moontwp@moontwp.com

January 6, 2012

Secretary Ray LaHood
U.S. Department of Transportation
1200 New Jersey Avenue, SE
Washington, DC 20590

Re: Ohio River Trail Council – 2012 TCSP Grant Application

Secretary LaHood:

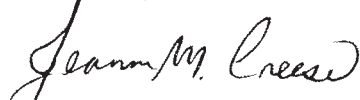
On behalf of the Moon Township Board of Supervisors and the citizens of Moon Township, please consider this a letter of support for a 2012 Transportation Community and System Preservation Program (TCSP) grant application for the above referenced project.

The proposed 2.5-mile bike and pedestrian trail segment of the Ohio River Trail in the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania is a critical link in the Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area that will link 27 municipalities, rebuild riverfronts, and provide a safe route for alternative transportation.

In addition, this project would also bring trail related economic benefits to our community and neighboring municipalities and make new opportunities for active transportation and recreation accessible to many residents in our region. In cooperation with the Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources, the Township of Moon is currently developing an abandoned brownfield site into a new Waterfront Park that will highlight the Sewickley Bridge and help to support the growing interest and economy focused around the Commonwealth's rivers and waterfront. The proposed trail would connect the Moon Township Waterfront Park with the pending Allegheny County Sports Complex and the existing Montour Trail.

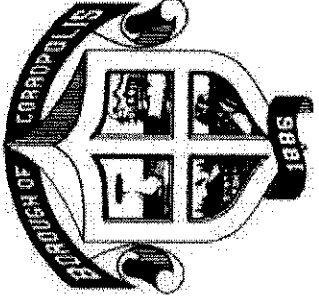
The Township of Moon thanks you for your leadership and requests that you give this application for funding your highest consideration.

Respectfully,



Jeanne M. Creese
Township Manager
Township of Moon

1012 Fifth Avenue
Coraopolis, PA 15108-1894



Telephone (412) 264-3002
Fax (412) 264-6951

January 6, 2012

Secretary Ray LaHood
U.S. Department of Transportation
1200 New Jersey Avenue, SE
Washington DC 20590

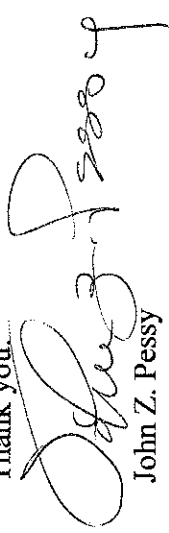
Secretary LaHood:

I am writing to express the support of the Coraopolis Borough Council for the Ohio River Trail Council's 2012 Transportation, Community and System Preservation Program (TCSP) grant application for the above referenced project.

Our understanding of the grant is for the design and engineering phase of your project. We are excited to learn of a viable way to travel through Coraopolis with the safety of the travelers in mind. The borough is not able to commit to matching funds at this time.

The Borough of Coraopolis appreciates your efforts in funding this project.

Thank you.


John Z. Pessy
President, Coraopolis Borough Council

COMMITTEE ON
ENERGY AND COMMERCE
SUBCOMMITTEES:
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COMMUNICATIONS AND TECHNOLOGY

CO-CHAIR:
COALITION FOR AUTISM
RESEARCH AND EDUCATION

CONGRESSIONAL CAUCUS ON ROBOTICS



Congress of the United States
House of Representatives

MIKE DOYLE

14TH DISTRICT, PENNSYLVANIA

January 4, 2012

The Honorable Ray H. LaHood
Secretary

U. S. Department of Transportation
1200 New Jersey Ave., SE
Washington, DC 20590-0001

Dear Secretary LaHood:

I am writing to offer my strong support of the Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program (TCSP) grant application submitted by the Ohio River Trail Council for a 2.5-mile bike and pedestrian segment of the Ohio River Trail in the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania.

This critical trail is a part of the Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area, located in a metropolis of 27 linked municipalities which have been working to recover from the economic downside of the industrial era and to rebuild the riverfronts to a point of pride. The Ohio River Trail will provide a safe route for alternative transportation on foot and on bicycles, and increase interest in the growing economies on the waterfront. This grant application is critical step toward achieving that goal.

The Ohio River Trail (ORT) project is a partnership project between the Ohio River Trail Council and the 27 municipalities along the 41-mile proposed trail that follows the shores of the Ohio River, just downstream from Pittsburgh. The Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (PA-DCNR) has supported this vision through grants for two Feasibility Studies – the North Shore and the South Shore sections. For this application, the focus is to start implementation of the ORT South Shore Trail Feasibility Study.

I strongly support this project and the application submitted by the Ohio River Trail Council. Please do not hesitate to contact me if you need any additional information.

Sincerely,

Mike Doyle
Member of Congress

WASHINGTON OFFICE:
401 CANNON HOUSE OFFICE BUILDING
WASHINGTON, DC 20515
(202) 225-2135

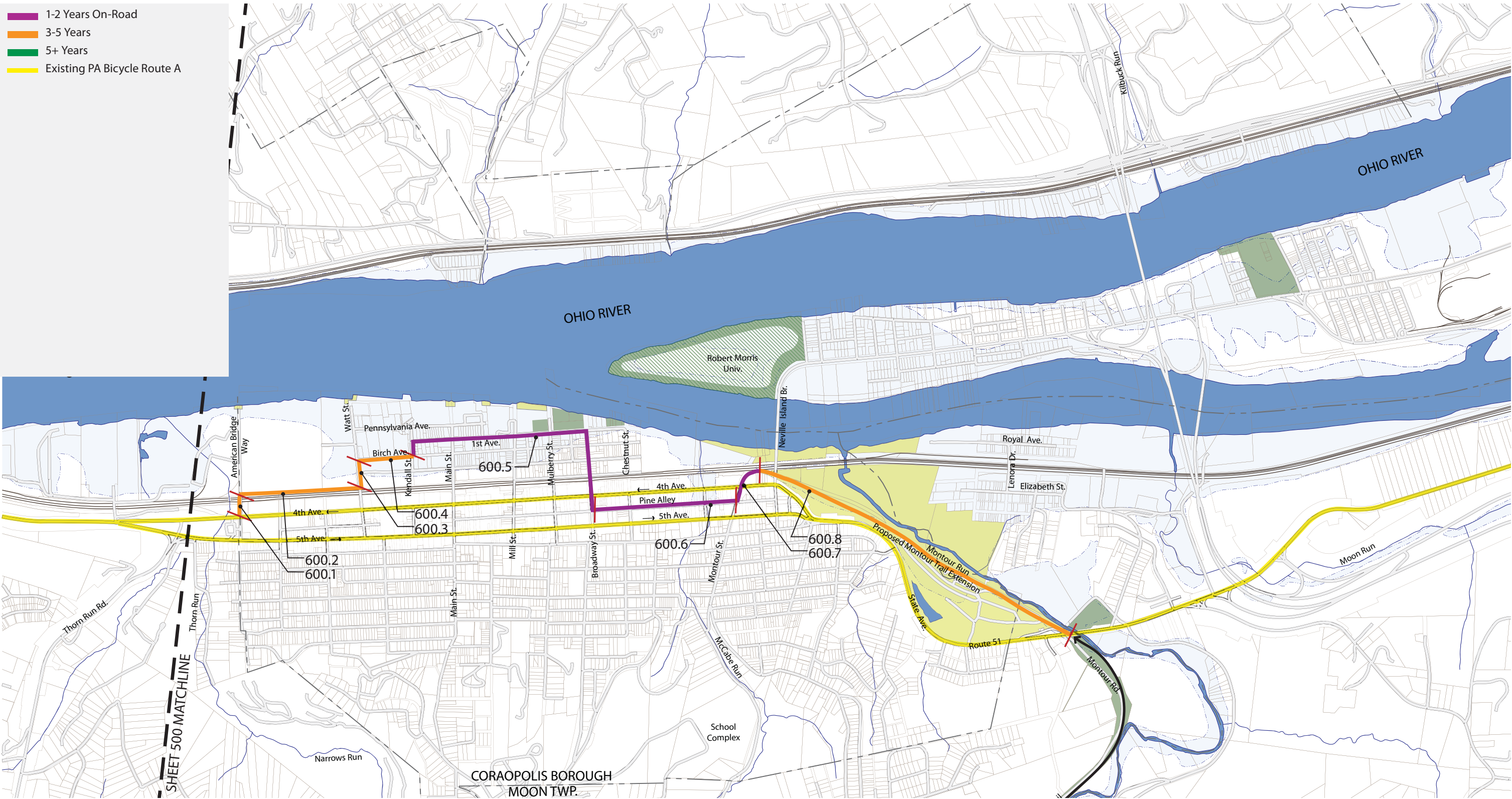
DISTRICT OFFICES:
2637 EAST CARSON STREET
PITTSBURGH, PA 15203
(412) 390-1499

11 DUFF ROAD
PENN HILLS, PA 15235
(412) 241-6055

627 LYSLE BOULEVARD
MCKEESPORT, PA 15132
(412) 664-4049

PROJECT PHASING

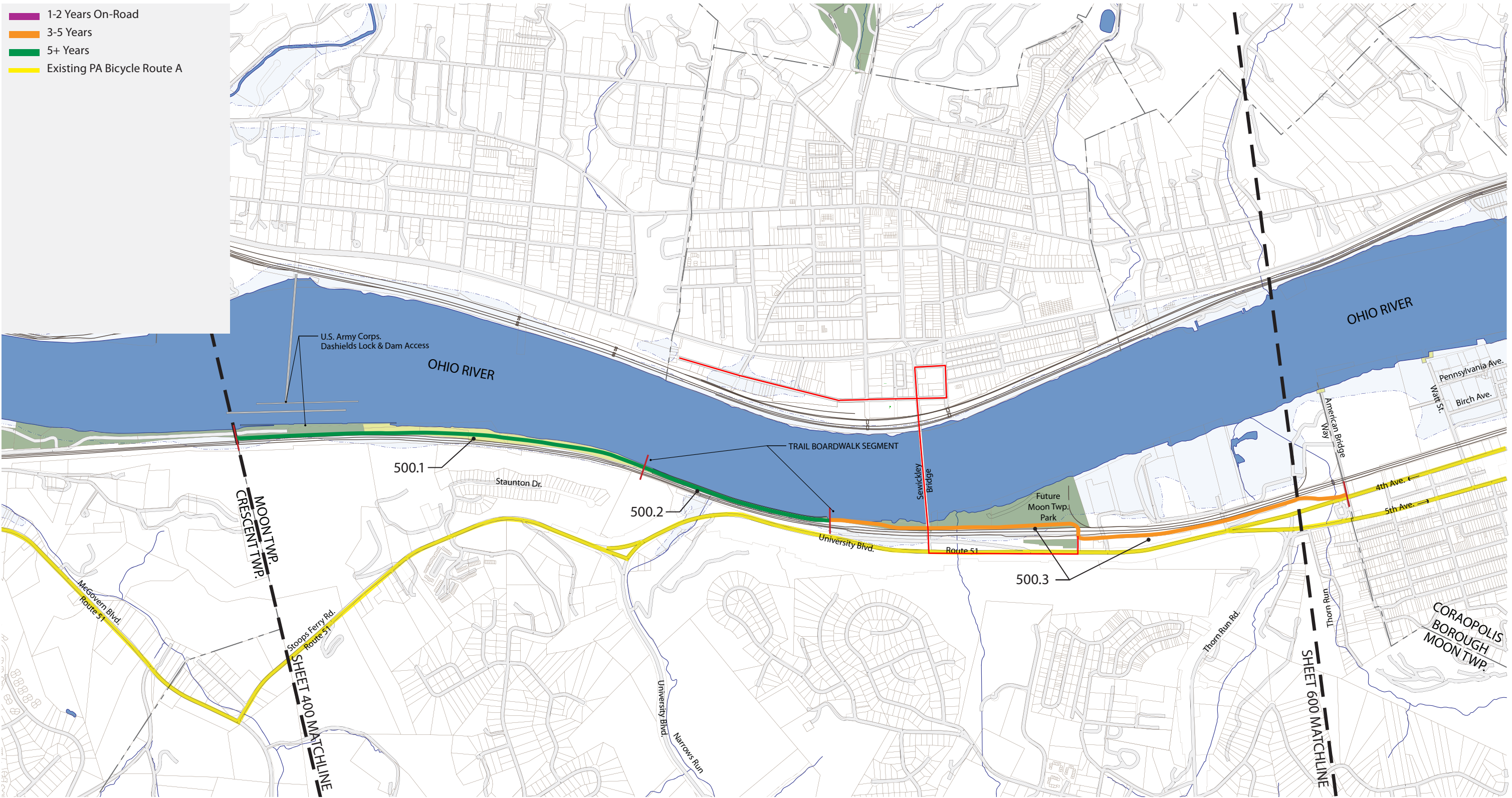
- 1-2 Years On-Road
- 3-5 Years
- 5+ Years
- Existing PA Bicycle Route A



SCALE: Not to Scale NORTH

PROJECT PHASING

- 1-2 Years On-Road
- 3-5 Years
- 5+ Years
- Existing PA Bicycle Route A



SCALE: Not to Scale NORTH